2. Knowledge of the use, care and maintenance of the cooker is required to prevent accidents.
3. Careful watch on the cooking time is necessary to prevent over cooking.

vii) Blanching

In meal preparation, it is often necessary only to peel off the skin of fruits and vegetables without making them tender. This can be achieved by the method of blanching. In this method food is dropped in boiling water for 5 seconds to 2 minutes depending on the texture of food. This helps to remove the skin without softening the food.

Blanching can also be done by pouring enough hot water on the food to immerse it for some time or subjecting foods to boiling temperatures for short periods and then immediately immersing them in cold water. This process causes the skin to become loose and then can be peeled off easily.

Merits:

1. Peels can easily be removed to improve digestibility.
2. Destroys enzymes that bring about spoilage.
3. Texture can be maintained, while improving the colour and flavor of the food.

Demerits:

1. Loss of nutrients if cooking water is discarded.



3.5.2 Dry Heat Methods

In this either air or fat is used as the medium of cooking.

3.5.2.1 Air as a Medium of Cooking

i) Grilling

Grilling consists of placing the food below or above or in between a red-hot surface. This results in the browning of the food.

Merits:

1. Quick method of cooking.
2. It improves the appearance, texture and flavour of the food.
3. Minimum oil is used.

Demerits:

1. Foods can be burnt due to carelessness.
2. Grilling denatures the proteins reducing their availability.

ii) Pan broiling or roasting

When food is cooked uncovered on heated metal or a frying pan, the method is known as pan-broiling, (e.g) chapathis.

Merits:

1. Quick method of cooking.
2. It improves the appearance, texture and flavor of the food.
3. Minimum oil is used.
4. Spices are easily powdered if they are first roasted.

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